

Laptop Hardware and Performance Runbook

Purpose: resolve common managed-laptop issues without risking employee data, electrical safety, warranty coverage, or security controls.

Safety first

- Stop using and disconnect power when safe if there is battery swelling, smoke, sparking, a burning smell, liquid ingress, or extreme heat.
- Do not puncture a battery, open the chassis, use an unapproved charger, or continue charging a damaged device.
- Report a lost or stolen laptop immediately through the approved security/support channel.
- Save work before restarts, updates, repair operations, or storage cleanup.

Rapid triage

- Record asset tag, model, operating system, power indicator state, exact symptoms, and recent changes.
- Disconnect optional USB devices and docks when testing startup or stability.
- Determine whether the issue affects hardware, one application, the user profile, or the whole operating system.

Power, Startup, and Boot Problems

No power or charging indicator

- Connect the approved charger directly to a known-working outlet and laptop, bypassing the dock.
- Inspect the cable and connector for visible damage without opening equipment.
- Wait five minutes, then try the normal power button once.
- If a removable accessory was connected when failure began, leave it disconnected for the test.
- No indicator with a known-good approved charger suggests charger, port, battery, or system-board failure; escalate.

Powers on but screen remains blank

- Increase brightness and disconnect external displays/docks.
- Listen for fans or startup sounds and note keyboard indicator behavior.
- Use only the manufacturer-approved display-output shortcut; do not repeatedly force power off during an update.
- If an external monitor works, report whether the internal screen shows a faint image or backlight.

Boot loop, recovery screen, or disk message

- Photograph the exact error with sensitive information removed.
- Do not initialize, format, repartition, or run destructive disk repair without IT approval.
- If the device requests a recovery key, obtain it only through the organization's approved recovery process; never publish the key.
- Repeated automatic repair, "no boot device," or encryption recovery prompts require IT.

Slow, Frozen, or Unstable Laptop

General slowness

- Save work, restart, and test before reopening every application.
- Open the built-in task monitor and record high CPU, memory, disk, or network use; do not terminate security or management processes.
- Close unnecessary browser tabs and approved applications. Pause large sync/download work and retest.
- Check free storage. Use approved cleanup tools; do not delete system, profile, or unknown application folders.
- Note whether slowness occurs only on battery, only when docked, or only in one application.

Freezes, crashes, or unexpected restart

- Record the time, active application, error code, and whether the laptop was hot.
- Apply pending company-approved updates after saving work and connecting power.
- Test once without optional peripherals. A stable result can isolate a dock, adapter, or peripheral.
- Repeated blue screens, kernel panics, or unexpected restarts require diagnostic collection by IT.

Overheating or loud fan

- Place the laptop on a hard, ventilated surface and clear external vent obstructions.
- Close unusually intensive applications and allow the device to cool.
- Do not use compressed air, liquids, or disassembly unless the approved hardware procedure allows it.
- Extreme heat, shutdowns, battery swelling, or odor is an immediate stop condition.

Battery, Display, Input, Audio, and Dock

Battery drains quickly

- Charge with the approved adapter and record percentage at the start and after 30 minutes of normal use.
- Reduce brightness, close unnecessary applications, and check the built-in battery-health status.
- Compare docked and direct-charger behavior. A battery that will not charge, drops suddenly, or is swollen requires service.

Screen or external monitor

- Reseat approved display cables and test the monitor's correct input.
- Bypass the dock once to isolate dock versus laptop output.
- Record flicker, lines, discoloration, dead areas, or whether the issue appears in a screenshot. Physical panel defects may not appear in screenshots.

Keyboard, touchpad, camera, microphone, or speakers

- Restart and test in a second approved application.
- Confirm mute/privacy switches and application device selection.
- Disconnect external input/audio devices to isolate the built-in component.
- Do not spray cleaner directly on the laptop. Report liquid damage immediately.

Docking station

- Disconnect the dock from power and laptop for 30 seconds, reconnect power, then the laptop.
- Test one peripheral at a time and compare a direct laptop connection.
- Record dock model, connection type, affected ports, and indicator state.

Laptop Verification and Escalation

Resolution checks

- The device starts normally twice and reaches the managed sign-in screen.
- The original application/task works after restart without abnormal heat or crashes.
- Charging, display, input, network, and dock behavior remain stable during a ten-minute test.
- Important work is saved and synchronization completes.

Contact IT immediately

- Swollen battery, smoke, odor, sparks, liquid damage, physical damage, or extreme heat.
- Lost/stolen device, encryption recovery prompt, missing boot device, or suspected malware.
- Repeated crashes, data-loss symptoms, failed company updates, or no power with an approved charger.

Standard ticket evidence

- Asset tag/model, operating system, location, employee contact, and business impact.
- Exact symptoms/error codes, indicator lights, temperature/power state, and timestamps.
- Dock/charger/peripherals involved, recent updates or impacts, and safe tests completed.
- Sanitized photos or screenshots. Do not attach confidential screen content or recovery keys.